

ABSTRACT

1. Passage anchor

> “First, drama turns **abstract knowledge** into lived understanding.”

Passage meaning

abstract = existing mainly as an idea or concept rather than something concrete, physical, or directly experienced

抽象的；概念性的

Here, **abstract knowledge** means ideas that students may understand only theoretically until drama helps them experience those ideas in a more concrete way.

Practice

1. Empathy can seem like an **abstract concept** until students face a real situation.

在學生真正面對情境之前，同理心可能只是一個**抽象概念**。

2. The activity helped turn **abstract ideas** into something easier to understand.

這項活動把**抽象概念**變得更容易理解。

Core meanings of ABSTRACT

2. abstract — conceptual rather than concrete

As an adjective:

= existing as an idea, quality, or concept rather than as a physical object or direct experience

抽象的；概念性的

Examples

1. Freedom is an **abstract idea**.

自由是一個**抽象概念**。

2. The theory is quite **abstract**.

這套理論相當**抽象**。

This is the exact passage sense.

3. abstract concept / idea

= idea that is not directly physical or concrete

****抽象概念；抽象思想****

Examples

1. Justice is an ****abstract concept****.

正義是一個****抽象概念****。

2. Children may find some ****abstract ideas**** difficult to understand.

孩子可能覺得某些****抽象概念****很難理解。

Abstract thinking

4. abstract thinking

= ability to think about ideas, patterns, principles, possibilities, etc. beyond immediate concrete objects or events

****抽象思考****

Examples

1. The activity encourages ****abstract thinking****.

這項活動鼓勵****抽象思考****。

2. Mathematics often requires ****abstract thinking****.

數學經常需要****抽象思考能力****。

Abstract knowledge

5. abstract knowledge

= knowledge understood theoretically or conceptually rather than through direct practical experience

****抽象知識；理論性知識****

This is the exact passage construction.

Examples

1. Students need opportunities to apply ****abstract knowledge****.

學生需要機會把**抽象知識**應用出來。

2. Drama can connect **abstract knowledge** with real situations.

戲劇可以把**抽象知識**與真實情境連結起來。

Abstract vs concrete

6. abstract — not concrete

= not tied to a specific physical example, object, or situation

非具體的；抽象的

Examples

1. The discussion remained too **abstract**.

討論仍然太過**抽象**。

2. Give students a concrete example instead of an **abstract explanation**.

與其給學生**抽象解釋**，不如提供具體例子。

Art

7. abstract — non-representational art

= art that does not try to represent objects, people, or scenes realistically

抽象的；抽象藝術的

Examples

1. She prefers **abstract art** to realistic painting.

比起寫實畫，她更喜歡**抽象藝術**。

2. The gallery displayed several **abstract paintings**.

畫廊展出了幾幅**抽象畫**。

Major distinct everyday cultural sense.

8. abstract art

= art using shapes, colors, lines, forms, etc. rather than realistic representation

****抽象藝術****

Examples

1. The exhibition focuses on ****abstract art****.
展覽以****抽象藝術****為主。
2. Some ****abstract art**** emphasizes color and movement.
有些****抽象藝術****強調色彩與動感。

Noun: summary

9. abstract — academic summary

As a noun:

= short summary of the main points of an article, research paper, thesis, report, etc.
****摘要；論文摘要****

Examples

1. Read the ****abstract**** before the full paper.
閱讀完整論文前先看****摘要****。
2. The journal requires a 250-word ****abstract****.
該期刊要求一篇二百五十字的****摘要****。

Major academic sense.

10. research abstract

= concise summary of a study's purpose, methods, findings, and conclusions
****研究摘要****

Examples

1. The ****research abstract**** summarizes the main findings.
****研究摘要****概述主要研究結果。
2. Conference submissions usually require an ****abstract****.
會議投稿通常需要提交****摘要****。

Verb: extract / remove

11. abstract — extract something

Formal/technical:

= remove, separate, or take something from a larger source

抽取；提取；抽離

Examples

1. The process **abstracts water** from the river.
這個程序從河流中**抽取水**。
2. Useful information was **abstracted from** the records.
有用資料從紀錄中被**提取出來**。

This is a genuine verb sense.

12. abstract something from something

= extract or separate something from a source

從.....抽取 / 提取某物

Examples

1. The researchers **abstracted data from** hospital records.
研究人員從醫院紀錄中**提取資料**。
2. Water is **abstracted from** underground sources.
水從地下水源中被**抽取**。

Verb: summarize

13. abstract — summarize information

Formal:

= make a summary of a document, article, set of records, etc.

摘要；概述

Examples

1. The researcher **abstracted** the key findings.
研究人員**概述**了主要研究結果。

2. The report was **abstracted** for the database.
報告被整理成**摘要**收入資料庫。

Much less common in everyday English than the noun **abstract**.

Computing / abstraction

14. abstract — remove unnecessary detail

Computing/technical:

= represent something at a higher level by hiding or ignoring lower-level implementation details
抽象化；**概括化**

Examples

1. The interface **abstracts away** the technical details.
這個介面把技術細節**抽象化** / **隱藏起來**。

2. The system **abstracts** complex operations into simpler components.
系統把複雜操作**抽象成**較簡單的元件。

15. abstraction — computing

= simplified representation that hides unnecessary implementation detail
抽象；**抽象層**；**抽象化**

Examples

1. Good software design often relies on **abstraction**.
良好的軟體設計經常依賴**抽象化**。

2. The API provides a useful **abstraction** over the database.
API 在資料庫之上提供了一層實用的**抽象層**。

16. abstract class

Object-oriented programming:

= class intended mainly to define shared structure/behavior for other classes and not usually instantiated directly

****抽象類別****

Examples

1. The program defines an ****abstract class**** for vehicles.

程式為車輛定義了一個****抽象類別****。

2. Concrete classes inherit from the ****abstract class****.

具體類別繼承自該****抽象類別****。

Established technical compound.

Mathematics

17. abstract — dealing with general structures rather than concrete numerical examples

= highly conceptual and concerned with general patterns or structures

****抽象的；抽象數學的****

Examples

1. The course introduces ****abstract algebra****.

這門課介紹****抽象代數****。

2. The proof becomes increasingly ****abstract****.

這個證明變得越來越****抽象****。

18. abstract algebra

= branch of mathematics studying algebraic structures such as groups, rings, and fields

****抽象代數****

Examples

1. She is studying ****abstract algebra****.

她正在學習**抽象代數**。

2. **Abstract algebra** focuses on general mathematical structures.

抽象代數研究一般性的數學結構。

Specialist but established.

ABSTRACTLY

19. abstractly

= in a conceptual or theoretical way rather than concretely

抽象地；概念上

Examples

1. It is easy to discuss the issue **abstractly**.

這個問題很容易只從**抽象層面**討論。

2. Students first considered the idea **abstractly**.

學生一開始只是**抽象地**思考這個概念。

ABSTRACTION

20. abstraction — abstract idea

= general concept separated from specific concrete examples

抽象概念；抽象化概念

Examples

1. “Justice” can become an **abstraction** if it is never linked to real cases.

如果從不連結真實情況，「正義」可能只會變成一個**抽象概念**。

2. The discussion moved from practical examples to **abstraction**.

討論從實際例子轉向了**抽象層面**。

21. abstraction — process of forming general concepts

= process of removing particular details in order to focus on general features

****抽象化；概括****

Examples

1. Mathematical reasoning often involves ****abstraction****.
數學推理經常涉及****抽象化****。
2. ****Abstraction**** allows us to identify common patterns.
****抽象化****讓我們辨認共同模式。

ABSTRACTED

22. abstracted — distracted / lost in thought

= so absorbed in thought that one pays little attention to surroundings
****心不在焉的；出神的****

Examples

1. He looked rather ****abstracted**** during the meeting.
他在會議期間看起來有點****心不在焉****。
2. She gave an ****abstracted smile**** and looked away.
她****心不在焉地笑了一下****，然後望向別處。

This is a genuinely distinct family meaning and an easy learner trap.

23. abstractedly

= in a distracted, absent-minded way
****心不在焉地；出神地****

Examples

1. He stared ****abstractedly**** out of the window.
他****出神地****望著窗外。
2. She nodded ****abstractedly****.
她****心不在焉地****點了點頭。

Formal/literary and lower priority.

In the abstract

24. in the abstract

= considered theoretically or generally, without reference to a specific real case

****抽象地；從理論上；不涉及具體情況地****

Examples

1. The idea sounds convincing ****in the abstract****.

這個想法****從理論上看****很有說服力。

2. It is easy to support the principle ****in the abstract****.

如果只作****抽象討論****，支持這項原則很容易。

Very high-value expression.

Abstract from reality / specifics

25. abstract something from its context

= mentally consider something separately from the specific context in which it occurs

****把.....從具體語境中抽離****

Examples

1. You cannot completely ****abstract the statement from its context****.

你不能完全把這句話****從語境中抽離出來****。

2. The model ****abstracts general principles from individual cases****.

這個模型從個別案例中****抽取一般原則****。

Abstract noun

26. abstract noun

Grammar:

= noun naming an idea, quality, state, feeling, etc. rather than a physical object

****抽象名詞****

Examples

1. “Freedom” is an **abstract noun**.
“Freedom” 是一個**抽象名詞**。
2. “Happiness” and “courage” are **abstract nouns**.
“Happiness” 和 “courage” 都是**抽象名詞**。

High-value language-learning compound.

Abstract expression / concept

27. abstract expression

= expression referring to a concept or quality rather than a concrete object
抽象表達；抽象概念表達

This remains within the main conceptual sense rather than being a new sense.

Abstract expressionism

28. abstract expressionism

= twentieth-century art movement emphasizing non-representational forms and expressive gesture
抽象表現主義

Examples

1. The museum has a collection of **Abstract Expressionist** paintings.
博物館收藏了一批**抽象表現主義**畫作。
2. **Abstract Expressionism** became influential in modern art.
抽象表現主義在現代藝術中影響深遠。

Established art term.

Abstract expressionist

29. abstract expressionist

= artist or artwork associated with Abstract Expressionism

****抽象表現主義藝術家 / 作品****

Specialist but culturally useful.

Key contrasts

30. abstract vs concrete

This is the most important contrast.

****abstract****

= existing mainly as an idea, principle, quality, or theory

****抽象的****

****concrete****

= specific, tangible, directly observable, or based on real examples

****具體的 ; 實在的****

Compare:

> abstract idea

> 抽象概念

> concrete example

> 具體例子

This contrast is central to the passage:

> ****abstract knowledge****

> → 理論 / 概念層面的知識

becomes:

> ****lived understanding****

> → 透過實際情境形成的理解

31. abstract vs theoretical

****theoretical****

= based on theory rather than practical application

****理論上的****

****abstract****

= conceptual and removed from concrete examples or physical reality

****抽象的****

They overlap, but:

> theoretical physics

> 理論物理

does not simply mean:

> abstract physics

32. abstract vs vague

****abstract****

= conceptual rather than concrete

****抽象的****

****vague****

= not clear or precise

****模糊的；不明確的****

An abstract idea can be explained very precisely.

So:

****abstract ≠ vague****

33. abstract vs general

****general****

= broad and not limited to one specific case

****一般的；概括的****

****abstract****

= removed from specific physical or practical examples

****抽象的****

A general statement is not necessarily abstract.

34. abstract vs summary

As nouns:

****abstract****

= concise formal summary, especially of an academic paper

****摘要****

****summary****

= general shortened account of the main points of anything

****摘要；總結****

Every academic abstract is a kind of summary, but not every summary is an abstract.

35. abstract vs extract

This is a useful spelling/meaning contrast.

****abstract****

= conceptual adjective; academic summary noun; extract/summarize verb

****抽象的 / 摘要 / 抽取****

****extract****

= remove or take something out; selected passage from a text

****提取；摘錄****

Compare:

> abstract of a paper

> 論文摘要

> extract from a novel

> 小說摘錄

36. abstract vs distracted

****abstracted****

= distracted because deeply lost in thought

****心不在焉的****

****abstract****

does not normally mean distracted.

Compare:

> abstract theory

> 抽象理論

> abstracted expression

> 心不在焉的神情

Meaning map

The central concept of ****abstract**** is:

****separating something from concrete particulars****

From this develop several branches.

A. Conceptual thinking

Passage

abstract knowledge

→ ****抽象 / 概念性知識****

Idea

abstract concept

→ ****抽象概念****

Thinking

abstract thinking

→ ****抽象思考****

B. Art

The artwork moves away from direct representation:

Abstract art

→ ****抽象藝術****

C. Academic summary

A document's main ideas are separated from the full details:

Abstract

→ ****摘要****

D. Extraction

Something is taken out of a larger source:

Abstract water/data from a source

→ ****抽取 / 提取****

E. Computing / mathematics

Implementation details or individual examples are removed to expose a general structure:

Abstraction

→ ****抽象化****

Abstract class

→ ****抽象類別****

Abstract algebra

→ ****抽象代數****

F. Mental distraction

Abstracted

→ **因沉浸思考而心不在焉**

This is a lexicalized family development and should be learned separately.

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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abstract — conceptual	主要存在於思想、原則、概念中，而非具體實物 / 直接經驗中的；抽象的
abstract concept/idea	非具體實物而屬於思想、品質、原則等的抽象概念
abstract thinking	超越具體事物、從概念與模式思考的抽象思考
abstract knowledge	主要在理論 / 概念層面掌握、未必有直接實際經驗的知識
abstract — non-concrete	不以具體例子、實物或特定情境呈現的
abstract — art	不以寫實方式描繪現實物件 / 人物的抽象藝術風格
abstract art	以色彩、形狀、線條等而非寫實再現為主的抽象藝術
abstract — academic noun	概括論文、研究等主要內容的正式摘要
research abstract	簡述研究目的、方法、結果等的研究摘要
abstract — extract verb	從較大來源中抽取 / 提取某物
abstract something from something	從某來源中提取、抽離某物
abstract — summarize verb	正式：把文件 / 資料整理成摘要
abstract — computing	隱藏具體實作細節，以較高層次方式表示 / 抽象化
abstraction — computing	用較簡化層次表示系統並隱藏細節的抽象 / 抽象層
abstract class	主要供其他類別繼承、通常不能直接建立實例的抽象類別
abstract — mathematics	關注一般結構、關係而非具體例子的抽象數學性質
abstract algebra	研究群、環、域等一般代數結構的抽象代數
abstractly	從概念 / 理論層面而非具體情況地
abstraction — concept	從具體個例中抽離出的抽象概念
abstraction — process	忽略個別細節、抽取共同特徵的抽象化過程
abstracted	因沉浸思考而沒有留意周圍；心不在焉的
abstractedly	心不在焉地；出神地
in the abstract	不考慮具體個案，只從一般 / 理論層面而言
abstract something from context	把某事從其具體語境 / 環境中抽離來看
abstract noun	表示概念、品質、狀態等而非具體物件的抽象名詞
Abstract Expressionism	以非寫實形式與強烈表現性為特徵的抽象表現主義

Passage recap

> “First, drama turns **abstract knowledge** into lived understanding.”

Here:

abstract = **conceptual or theoretical rather than concrete, physical, or directly experienced**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **抽象的**

* **概念性的**

Natural contextual translation:

首先，戲劇把抽象知識轉化為親身體會的理解。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

abstract

= **existing mainly as an idea or concept rather than as something concrete or directly experienced**

抽象的；概念性的

The biggest learner splits are:

> **abstract idea**

> → **抽象概念**

> **abstract art**

> → **抽象藝術**

but as a noun:

> **paper abstract**

> → **論文摘要**

and as a verb:

> **abstract data from records**

> → **從紀錄中提取資料**

Then in computing:

> **abstraction**

> → **抽象化**

> ****abstract class****

> → ****抽象類別****

And one especially easy trap:

> ****abstracted person****

> → ****心不在焉 / 出神的人****

not simply “抽象的人”.

The crucial passage contrast is:

> ****abstract knowledge****

> → 只停留在概念 / 理論層面的理解

versus:

> ****lived understanding****

> → 透過實際情境和體驗形成的理解

So the passage uses the core ****conceptual-not-concrete**** sense, which is central to the writer's argument that drama makes ideas more tangible and experientially meaningful.